

Fix the portfolio's efficiency. Use the festival as the engine.

My first month as Music Creator Manager · Belle He · August 2026 · “From your room to the main stage.”

1 · COACH BY ARCHETYPE

The portfolio's problem is **efficiency, not effort**: the most active creators are declining. One verdict and one plan per creator.

→ page 3

2 · FESTIVAL AS ENGINE, NOT EVENT

The **Road to Pulse Creator Program** recruits new music creators, re-energizes existing ones, and engineers the heat instead of hoping for it.

→ pages 4-6

3 · BASELINE-DISCIPLINED DELIVERY

Targets are set against a defined baseline, **leading indicators gate every dollar**, with a hard go/no-go checkpoint at week 4.

→ pages 2, 7-8

\$80K

activation budget

8 weeks

to festival, five phases

5 + open

managed creators + open recruitment

ROI ≈ 5-6x

target, convention to confirm

OBJECTIVES & BASELINE

Scope, baseline, targets: in that order

Vertical definition, measurement conventions and targets, set before any action starts.

1 · VERTICAL DEFINITION & SIZING

- **Pan-music creators:** singing, instruments, DJ sets, production. Broad at the vertical level, precise per creator
- The five managed creators are the showcase anchors; recruitment extends to short-video musicians
- Persona: **16-34, urban, EDM / DJ-culture adjacent;** DJ sets, remixing, singer-songwriters, instrumentalists — validate wk 1
- Illustrative sizing: tens of thousands of tagged music creators in market, roughly a quarter not yet LIVE; tooling + manual tagging refine this in week 1

2 · BASELINE DISCIPLINE

- Baseline = **7-day averages** at period start and end, outlier days (platform mega-campaigns) removed
- Success is read as **campaign period vs baseline**, never raw totals
- Key campaign actions are scheduled **inside the measurement window**

3 · TARGETS, WITH A BASIS

- **Vertical:** daily streaming actives +8-10%, daily revenue +12-15% vs baseline (illustrative); actives carried by tail and new creators, revenue by the top
- **Campaign top creators:** revenue +100%+ during campaign, paying-user share +30-40%, per-payer spend +20-45%, follower growth
- **ROI $\approx$ 5-6x:** campaign-period revenue $\div$ \$80K (convention to confirm)
- Basis: comparable-campaign history; locked against internal baseline data in week 1

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION I WOULD REQUEST

Internal tier standards and where the five sit · content profiles · ROI & measurement conventions (campaign vs baseline?) · traffic sources, payer concentration, 90-day trends · MoM 0.09/0.22 read as +9%/+22%

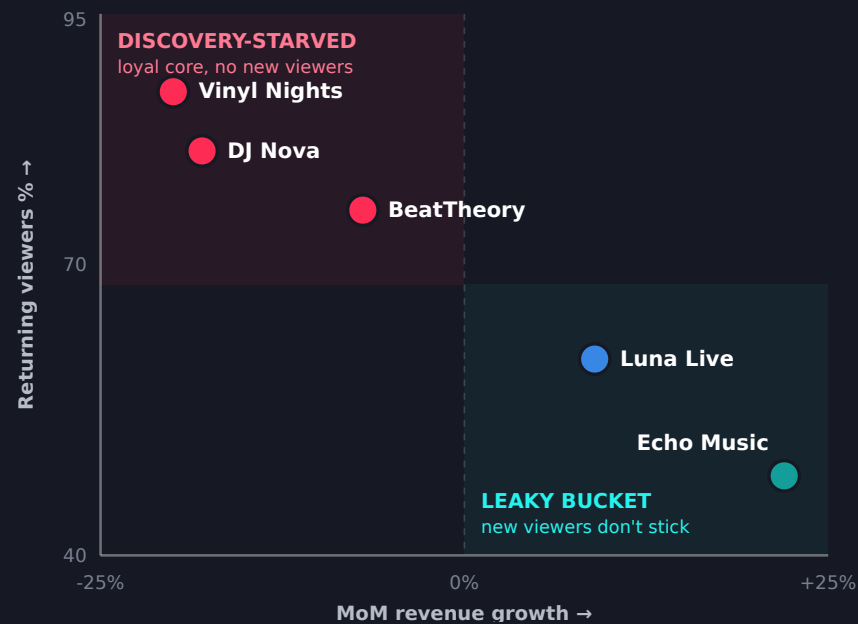
The most active creators are declining: an efficiency problem, not an effort problem

Last 30 days. Revenue per LIVE hour spans 5× across the portfolio.

CREATOR	LIVE HRS	AVG CCV	REVENUE	REV / HR	MOM	RETURNING
● Echo Music	38	1,250	\$12,100	\$318	+22%	48%
● Luna Live	58	910	\$17,600	\$303	+9%	60%
● DJ Nova	115	430	\$14,200	\$123	-18%	81%
● BeatTheory	90	310	\$10,400	\$116	-7%	75%
● Vinyl Nights	126	185	\$7,800	\$62	-20%	87%

Hours and growth are **inversely related**: the two creators streaming the most are declining fastest. The portfolio needs **better hours, not more hours**. Portfolio-level: **\$62.1K** total, weighted MoM **-3.4%**; Luna + Echo generate **48% of revenue on 23% of the hours**.

RETURNING VIEWERS VS. REVENUE GROWTH (MOM)



ONE VERDICT PER CREATOR · BACK THE WINNERS, FIX THE LEAKS · PER-CREATOR COACHING METRICS: P.8

- Echo · BACK P1** — momentum is perishable: fixed schedule, 1v1 dedicated management, welcome rituals + fresh hooks, fan-community VIP events to consolidate payers
- Nova · FIX** — refreshed show formats + new segments, off-peak tests, festival stage slot as a new-audience injection
- BeatTheory · HOLD** — prevention: Luna’s playbook, monthly format experiment, echo-chamber alerts

- Luna · BACK** — codify her playbook portfolio-wide; gentle hours increase; balance can mean a ceiling, content review first
- Vinyl · FIX** — fewer, better hours (126 → ~80), new formats, co-streams with risers, creator×fan second-creation missions
- Overall** — three patterns: leaky-bucket risers, discovery-starved loyalists, balanced. Moves fit stable-but-stalling creators; avoid homogenized content. Keep a **10% backup roster**

One festival, three funnels: recruit the new, energize the existing, showcase the top

The plan: “**From Your Room to the Main Stage**” · the **Road to Pulse Creator Program**, in five phases; excitement is the output of the three funnels below, clipped and amplified.

1 · Sign-up & warm-up · W1-2

2 · Launch · W2

3 · Online rounds · W3-6

4 · Festival weekend · W7-8

5 · Post-festival push · W8+

detail: p.7

RECRUIT

The **Rising division** of Road to Pulse: a dedicated on-ramp for musicians who have never gone LIVE. Short-video missions count as entry, so the funnel starts one level below the official campaigns' eligibility gates.

Feeds: daily streaming actives, new-creator supply

ENERGIZE

Existing creators compete in the **Headliner division**; a 4-week bootcamp covers streaming craft and the monetization ladder; portfolio creators mentor and perform, which doubles as their discovery fix.

Feeds: engagement, revenue, portfolio recovery

SHOWCASE

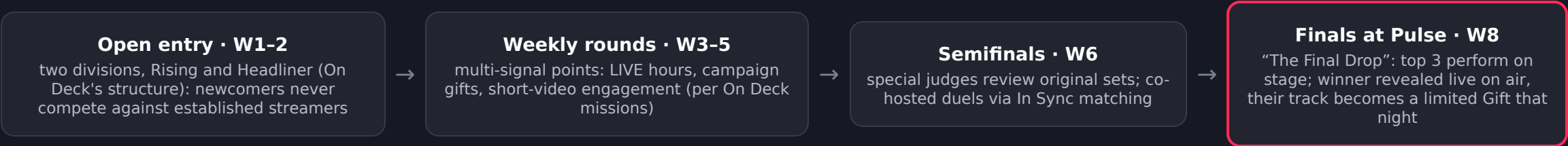
The **TikTok LIVE stage at Pulse**: competition finals and top-talent performances, all streamed to the platform. The stream is the product for the 99% who are not on site.

Feeds: platform heat, brand, showcase goal

Budget sits in the appendix (p.8), concentrated on stage + competition: they compound, and marketing amplifies what they create.

"Road to Pulse", modeled on On Deck: Breakaway, with the entry gate the official campaigns don't have

Proven architecture, deliberately copied. My changes target what On Deck leaves open: recruiting pre-LIVE musicians, and day-31 aftercare.



THE REWARD LADDER (ON DECK'S DESIGN: CAREER CAPITAL OVER CASH)

WHO	REWARD	COST
All entrants	Pulse avatar frame + campaign badge	≈ \$0, platform asset
Round winners	Diamonds + festival merch	low
Semifinalists	VIP Pulse tickets, travel covered	the bulk of \$18K
Top 3	Stage slot + distribution support (as in Music On Stage) + own track released as a limited-run LIVE Gift (as in Songs of LIVE)	≈ \$0, platform access

Even On Deck's cash-equivalent prizes are modest: the top of the ladder isn't bought, it's platform access. That's why \$18K is enough.

INSIDE EVERY ENTRANT'S ROOM (ON DECK'S PRODUCTION MECHANICS)

- Campaign-exclusive **Pulse Gift** with in-room counter
- **Milestone progress bar**: gift-point thresholds unlock the next reward tier
- **Live rank badge** shown in the room; leaderboard resets weekly
- **Shout-out segment**: entrants thank top supporters on air, a built-in retention ritual

I watched these mechanics run live in On Deck rooms; they double as coaching material for the portfolio.

Runs alongside: education and the pipeline. A 4-week bootcamp covers streaming craft and the 1K → Gifts → Subscriptions → Rewards ladder, with portfolio creators as mentors. After the festival, every entrant enters a 30-day incubation track (first LIVE within 2 weeks, 3 streams/week by day 30). On Deck itself runs different missions per tier; the platform already coaches by archetype, and I apply the same logic inside the portfolio.

Ignition: trending words, planted moments, fan second-creation

On TikTok, hot lists run on derivative clips and planted moments. Nothing ignites from a cold start.

MAKING IT TREND

- **Anthem co-creation:** a star artist records the festival anthem in warm-up; creators cover it, fans duet it. Every trending word and challenge hangs off the program's big idea
- **Planted show moments:** engineered contrast pairings (A×B co-streams) turned into events, pushed with trending-topic words in 2-day concentrated bursts
- **Top creators post through the campaign:** participation ≥80% is a tracked target; amplifier accounts scale the clips

CREATOR × FAN SECOND CREATION

- **Fan clip missions:** second-creation submissions ranked by like tiers, with reward ladders
- **Invited 1v1:** offered to high-stickiness, mass-fan creators; payer structure decides who runs fan campaigns
- **Open clip rights + attendee UGC:** booth QR prompts festival-goers to post; best fan clips hit the stage screens

ON-SITE & PARTNERS

- **Sponsorship** covers non-content site costs; stage & show programming curated from competition winners; creator-level QR attribution on stage and booth
- **Program team** is measured on qualified creators + platform heat; we deliver pre-event posting in return
- **BD team** assists recruitment; **product team** ships custom event effects; **labels** clear licensing from W1; VIP-ticket inventory and booth placement locked in the SLA

PROJECT PLAN

Kickoff first: results-based milestones, weekly cadence

PHASE	WEEKS	WHAT HAPPENS	MILESTONE (EXIT CRITERIA)
1 · Sign-up & warm-up	W1-2	Kickoff: plan + budget + ROI aligned, one owner per workstream; creator 1:1s; licensing starts; anthem co-creation seeds warm-up; BD / agency outreach	Entries at target; prep complete
2 · Launch	W2	Campaign mechanics tested and live; offline build kicks off from W3	Test pass; campaign live
3 · Online rounds	W3-6	Weekly leaderboards in two divisions (W3-5); W4 entries go/no-go ; judges review original sets at the semifinal (W6)	Finalists locked end of W6; go/no-go passed
4 · Festival weekend	W7-8	Full rehearsal and logistics locked (W7); “The Final Drop” finale, stage showcases, discovery booth, QR attribution (W8)	All sessions delivered as scheduled
5 · Post-festival push	W8+	30-day incubation for every entrant; recap clips keep the tail warm	W+4 retention report; D30 ≥ 40%

Running in parallel across all phases: archetype coaching (W1-8) · marketing & second-creation (W3-8) · offline build (W3-7)

BIGGEST RISKS → MITIGATIONS

Music licensing gaps	Confirm rights + replacement tracks from W1; no uncleared set reaches the stage
Recruitment shortfall (entries or dropout)	Agency pre-commitments; 20-30% outreach over-provision + 10% backup roster; W4 checkpoint triggers paid boost
On-site tech failure	Redundant streaming setup + full rehearsal in W7
Gift-vote gaming	Judge-score gate + anomaly monitoring on voting patterns
Partner deliverables slip	SLA with weekly sync; stage specs frozen at W6
Budget overrun	8% contingency + weekly burn review
On-site content / brand safety	Dedicated moderation coverage for all festival streams; escalation path agreed with Trust & Safety in advance

STAKEHOLDERS

Internal: Product (custom event effects & tools), Data Science, Marketing, Legal & Music Licensing, Event Ops

External: Pulse festival org & program team (their metric: qualified creators + platform heat), BD / agency partners for recruitment, labels & artists

KEEPING IT ON TRACK

W1 kickoff alignment (plan + budget + ROI) · preset standards → layered execution → real-time calibration: daily/weekly data reviews, underperforming metrics trigger immediate adjustment · one owner per workstream · live dashboard on entries, coaching metrics, budget burn

SUCCESS METRICS

Measure supply first: revenue follows

Targets are set from comparable-campaign history; week 1 locks them against a 7-day, outlier-trimmed baseline.

LAYER	METRIC	ILLUSTRATIVE TARGET
Leading · supply	Competition entries · first-time LIVE creators · portfolio quality-weighted hours · bootcamp completion	500+ entries; 150+ first LIVEs; completion ≥ 60%
Process · engagement	Music-vertical watch time during campaign · portfolio new-viewer share · average concurrent viewers	New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl; ACV ↑ portfolio-wide
Lagging · revenue & health	Portfolio revenue MoM · revenue per LIVE hour · paying-user share · per-payer spend · campaign ROI · D30 retention of recruits	MoM positive by W8; payer share +30–40%; per-payer spend +20–45%; ROI ≈ 5–6×; D30 ≥ 40%
Coaching · per creator	Streaming actives & hours · watch UV · follower growth · paying-user share · per-payer spend · watch → pay conversion	Per-creator targets set in W1 1:1s against each baseline
Guardrails · execution	On-site sessions delivered as scheduled · rights & safety incidents · budget adherence	≥ 90% delivered; zero material incidents; within \$80K

Supply and retention are the cause; revenue is the effect. I act on leading metrics and am judged by lagging ones.

APPENDIX · THE \$80K ACTIVATION BUDGET

LIVE stage & on-site production	\$28K	Competition prizes & finalist travel	\$18K	Marketing & community	\$16K
Creator bootcamp & education	\$8K	On-site ops & logistics	\$4K	Contingency (~8%)	\$6K

Creator-directed spend splits ≈50% to top + high-potential creators (traffic boosts, content support), the rest to new-creator recruitment. Pacing ≈40% warm-up / 40% campaign & festival / 20% post-festival tail, contingency dynamic. Platform traffic and product support are in-kind.

Recommendation: approve this plan, subject to week 1 validation of baseline data, the rights inventory, and partner deliverables.